



Twitter's MD for China

Twitter just appointed its first Managing Director for China, previously working for Cisco and Microsoft. <http://dgit.in/TwtrMDC>



Shuddle shuts down

Shuddle the Uber like service for kids shuts down on 15 April 2016. <http://dgit.in/shuddleshuts>

Budget TVs



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Our Zero1 Award Winner in the TV category, this year, was one LG 4K Curved OLED TV. Everyone, here at the Digit Test Labs, has been spoiled by that television, but just like most of you guys, we can't afford it. Which brings us to the point. Have you noticed those inexpensive televisions doing the rounds on Flipkart, Amazon and other e-commerce websites? We've reviewed a bunch of them, and they seem quite good. Yes, there are compromises, but at a price tag less than ₹40k, few would really complain.

Vu is perhaps one of the best known names on this side of the market, and the competition is still quite tough. We often get queries about which TV one should pick in this price range, and sometimes, even we're in a fix. How does one solve such a dilemma? By comparison of course. We picked three of the most promising budget televisions in the market. They all lie in the 50 inch category, and they all have that 'is this even possible!' factor going for them.

Budget TVs have also been eating into the the bigger players' market share. The fact is that giants like LG, Samsung, and Sony are selling 30-40 inch televisions at the same prices that Vu, Intex and others are selling 50-inch TVs for. While this is good for consumers, and every home can have big screen TVs, it's also a difficult choice. Many have asked us whether these budget televisions are worth buying, and after having reviewed many of them, we can confirm that they indeed are. It is now time to decide which TV is the best to buy amongst these budget televisions.

How We Tested

At this price, compromises are expected, especially when it comes to TVs. We don't expect budget televisions to look and feel as good as high-end LG, Samsung or Sony TVs. That being said, compromise shouldn't result in shoddy work. Hence, we covered the features and design category. We took the material used into consideration. More importantly, features like viewing angles and weight were measured.

Budget TVs often tend to come with non-responsive UIs, which can be a problem in the long run. So, we rated the UI of each of these televisions, on ease of use, responsiveness, and the remote. The remote is actually a very important part. High-end TVs today come with Android, Tizen or WebOS, and they have

advanced remotes. For budget televisions, it is important to have responsive remotes, with well placed, easy to press and buttons. Also, the remote must not be confusing.

But none of that is more important than performance. It's a TV after all, and all that really matters is the picture quality. We measured the Contrast Ratio, Black levels at different brightness settings, white saturation at various brightness levels, and the general brightness of the TV. These were done using specialised equipment, along with software-based tools as well. We also measured the colour levels on the display, against sRGB, NTSC and AdobeRGB levels. All this was followed by ratings based on our favourite TV shows - Daredevil, Narcos

and Fuller House, streamed at HD quality. Next, the audio output was taken into consideration, based on both, the loudness and the rated output of the speakers attached. The placement of the speakers often determines whether a speaker suits a large room, or will fit smaller ones.

Lastly, the number of HDMI ports, USB ports, headphone outs etc. were taken into consideration. This is another area where compromises are forgiven, but not enough to hamper usage in the long term. So, missing smart features are still fine, but too few ports aren't.

Our competitors were the Vu Play Series 50-inch FHD TV, the InFocus 50-inch FHD TV and the Intex 50-inch FHD TV.